

HISTORY CLASS 12: MOST IMPORTANT PYQs

Sets 61/5/1 & 61/7/1 Comprehensive Analysis | @THUNDERSTUDY

Section A: Ancient India (Harappan to 600 CE)

The Harappan Civilization

- **Craft & Subsistence:** "Explain the strategies adopted by Harappans to procure raw material for their craft production." and "Explain how archaeologists have been able to reconstruct dietary practices of the Harappans."
- **Urban Planning:** "How do the archaeological discoveries at Harappa explain urban planning of the Indus Valley Civilization?"
- **Archaeological History:** "Describe the contributions of various archaeologists (Cunningham, Marshall, Wheeler) from 1875 till 1950 in discovering the Harappan civilization."

Early States and Societies (c. 600 BCE – 600 CE)

- **Inscriptions:** "Although inscriptions provide strong evidence for reconstructing history yet there are few limitations to these evidences. Justify the statement."
- **Social Structures:** "How was the patriliney system important among the elite families from sixth century BCE onwards?" and "How did different types of marriages reflect the social systems of ancient India during the Mahabharata Period?"
- **Significance:** "The sixth century BCE was a period of emergence of early states, empires and diverse thoughts in the early Indian history. Justify."

Cultural Developments

- **Sanchi Stupa:** Questions often focus on the role of the **Begums of Bhopal** (Shahjehan Begum) in preserving the stupa.
- **Puranic Hinduism:** "How has Puranic Hinduism contributed to the development of Vaishnavism and Shaivism?"

Section B: Medieval India

Bhakti-Sufi Traditions

- **Guru Nanak:** "Baba Guru Nanak Dev ji advocated a form of 'Nirguna Bhakti'. Substantiate the statement."
- **Sufism:** "The Chistis became the most influential Sufi devotional tradition in the late twelfth century. Explain."
- **Mirabai:** Explain the emotions of devotion in Mirabai's poetry.
- **Kabir:** Kabir Das as an outstanding example of a poet-saint.

Vijayanagara Empire

- **Architecture:** "The Virupaksha Temple is a historic temple located in Hampi. What features make it a key architectural and cultural landmark?" and "Why was the 'Mahanavami Dibba' a centre of main Vijayanagara rituals?"
- **Fortification:** "Examine the distinctive aspects of the fortification of the Vijayanagar empire."
- **Rise & Decline:** Examine the main reasons for the rise and decline of the Vijayanagar empire.

The Mughal Empire

- **Agrarian Relations:** "Ain-i-Akbari is considered a major source for the agrarian history of the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries. Examine the statement."
- **Village Society:** "Examine the position of Zamindars in the Mughal Village Society." and the role of **Panchayats** in rural society.
- **Chronicles:** "The paintings in the Mughal Chronicles possess special powers to communicate ideas about the power of king and kingdom."

Section C: Modern India

Colonialism and Rural Society

- **Bengal:** "The jotedars were more effective than that of zamindars in the villages. Examine the statement in the context of Permanent Settlement."
- **Rajmahal Hills:** "Examine how the lives of Paharias in the hills of Raj Mahal, were intimately connected to the forests."
- **Deccan:** Causes of the revolt by ryots against moneylenders (Deccan Riots).

Revolt of 1857

- **British Response:** "The British used military power on gigantic scale and passed number of Acts to suppress the Revolt of 1857."
- **Proclamations:** "The Rebel proclamations of 1857 appealed to all the sections of the

population for Unity."

- **Visual Representation:** "How has Indian imagery (art and literature) preserved Rani Laxmibai's contribution during the Revolt of 1857?"

Mahatma Gandhi & National Movement

- **Salt Satyagraha:** "Explain the reasons behind Gandhiji's decision to initiate the Salt Satyagraha and why did this movement become a significant event?"
- **Quit India:** "Explain why the 'Quit India Movement' was considered a mass movement."
- **Non-Cooperation:** Describe the circumstances that led to the Non-Cooperation Movement.
- **Sources:** "Various sources are essential for a complete understanding of Gandhiji's contributions in the Indian National Movement."

Framing the Constitution

- **Federalism:** "The draft constitution provided for three lists of subjects on the issue of federalism. Explain."
- **Ideals:** Questions based on the "Objectives Resolution" and the definition of India as a "Sovereign Republic".

Important Source-Based Topics

- ✓ **Buddhism:** Passages from the *Sutta Pitaka* advising wealthy householders (Sigala).
- ✓ **Travelers:** Al-Biruni's description of Sanskrit and Bernier's description of **Karkhanas**.
- ✓ **Mughal Court:** Abu'l Fazl's description of **Darbar-i-Akbari**.
- ✓ **Constitution:** Nehru's speech on the "Republic" and democratic institutions.

Map Work Items

Harappan Sites: Banawali, Lothal, Dholavira.

Buddhist Sites: Bodh Gaya, Bharhut, Sanchi.

1857 Centres: Delhi, Meerut, Jhansi, Lucknow, Kanpur, Gwalior, Arrah.

National Movement: Champaran, Dandi, Amritsar (Jallianwala Bagh).

Imperial Cities: Vijayanagara (Hampi), Agra, Delhi, Goa.